before granting any compensation. Accordingly, a route was de-mined by the Army and a party set off towards Dalunang, only to be fired on by the Pakistanis who were already sitting there, having intruded on our side of the LC. Two Companies of a Punjab Battalion were hastily rushed up to contain this intrusion, led by Maj RR Nimbhorkar.[5] Over a period of time, the position had been fortified and was then occupied by an entire Battalion.

On arrival at the Bn HQ, I reported to the CO, Col GPS Bedi, who had taken over from Col Dhariwal. Col Bedi told me to take over as the Adjutant, which was a big comedown from the BM appointment I was holding earlier. Based on my Sunderbani experience, I made only one request to the CO, and that was to allow me to go to all the posts, at least up to all the Company HQs, before getting behind a desk. That request was turned down on the plea that this familiarization round would take at least a week to ten days. Since we were moving out in any case, in about a month, why bother? I was not entirely happy with this outlook but after much persuading, I did manage to get permission to go up to our own post of Dalunang, which was dominated on all sides by the Pakistanis. This move had to be carried out at night, moonless nights at that, since portions of the track were under observation from the Pakis, who would open speculative fire on these exposed stretches. At Dalunang, one had to perforce stay the whole day, being able to move back only after darkness had set in. Against this backdrop, we ought to have been more careful and on the lookout for any such clandestine intrusion attempts, which did occur in the same area in 1999, leading to the Kargil War.

It would be more than three months before we finally moved out to Meerut. It was the second time I had joined the Battalion just as it was leaving HAA, not allowing me to earn

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